

appear to be fine, try adding Framing Errors and Timeout Errors from **Edit > Add Item > Dial-Up Networking Adapter** to pinpoint the problems in your connection.

Automatic re-dialling

If you often need to dial more than once before you connect through your ISP, you can setup automatic redialling. This can be done by going to **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications > Dial-Up Networking > Connection Name > Settings**. Check Redial, and select the number of times that you want to re-dial (between 2 and 100). To wrap it up, click OK and close Dial-Up Networking.

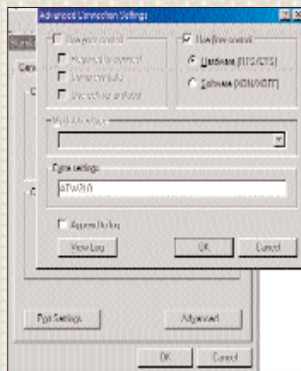
Honest modems

When you open up the modem icon from the system tray, it indicates the speed at which the computer and modem communi-

...Speed it up

New Windows

A single page may take its own sweet time to load, so optimise your time by opening links in new windows. To open a Web page hotlink in a new window, hold down [Shift] as you click on the hotlink; this is faster than right-clicking and selecting 'Open Link in New Window'. This is particularly useful when you have a Web page that has numerous links that you want to open as you read the Web page. Note that this will not work with JavaScript pages.



Getting your modem's truthful speeds

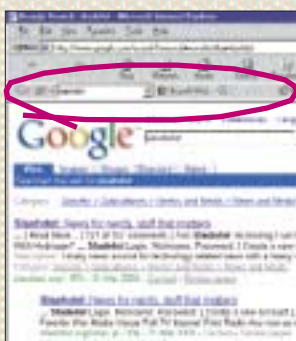
cate. But this is not the true data transfer speed—the speed at which your modem communicates with the modem on the other side is the true speed. To see this, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > Modems > Properties > Connection**. Click on the advanced button and in the Extra settings, put ATW2L0. You should now get the correct speed.

Faster Searching

To search in Internet Explorer 5 or greater, instead of jumping to your favourite search engine, press [Ctrl] + [E]. The Search pane opens into MSN search. Here, choose your category, enter the search term you're looking for, and click Search.

Smart Searching

If you are one of those who trusts Google to get to a page worth your while, then you should get hold of the Google search bar



Smart searching with search toolbars

(toolbar.google.com). Most popular search engines, such as Google, Yahoo!, Ask Jeeves and Toema, have free search toolbars that are tightly integrated into Internet Explorer. These toolbars make searching online quicker and easier.

Speeding up

You can speed up navigation within Explorer 5 or Explorer 6 by disabling page transitions. To make this change, in Explorer, go to **Tools > Internet Options**. Under the Advanced tab, disable the option for 'Enable Page Transitions' and click OK. This will allow for faster browsing.

Faster loading

If a text or graphics-heavy page takes a long time to download its graphics, hitting F5 or clicking Refresh can speed up the loading the second time.

Automatic refreshing

IE cache keeps a record of the Web pages you have visited; this can be used to retrieve



Automatic refreshing: Enabling and disabling it

those pages faster. To change any cache settings, go to **Tools > Internet Options > General > Settings**. To automatically check for updated versions of visited pages, enable the 'Automatically' option under 'Check for newer versions of stored pages:'. This will give you faster and updated versions of the Web pages you frequently visit.

...Or disabling it

You may want to disable the above feature, if the pages you visit are not updated very often. To do this, set the option to Never. If you want to open the latest version of the page, click Refresh, or press F5.

Cache Sizes

If you want to store versions of the Web pages that you visit, adjust the amount of space in your cache. Go to **Tools > Internet Options** and select General. Move the slider to select the amount of hard disk space you would like to devote to your cache. Ideally, keep aside about 75 to 100 MB. 



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